Ximena Marín Sánchez

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SUMMARY

Hardworking and persistent Computer Science student with an emphasis in Information Technology, and a curiosity that spans science, art, and poetry. I love learning new things, and when projects bring unexpected challenges, I find a way to solve them. I chose technology because it lets me help people, from my family's everyday tech problems to my students' questions, and I want to bring that same purpose to infrastructure and customer support.

EDUCATION

Universidad de Costa Rica **Final year student**
BSc in Computer Science

EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant **Mar 2026 - Present**
Universidad de Costa Rica, School of Computer Science *San José, Costa Rica*

- Supported two courses per semester: Computer Systems Security, Databases, and Software Engineering & Databases Integrative Project.
- Resolved students' technical questions and graded assignments, labs, and quizzes with constructive feedback.
- Maintained clear, direct communication with professors to meet course expectations.

HARD SKILLS

Systems: Linux administration and hardening (Rocky Linux, Kali Linux), Windows, Basic troubleshooting
Infrastructure: VMware ESXi, VirtualBox, DHCP, DNS, Firewall, IPsec VPN, SSH (WSL)
Scripting & Docs: Bash, Python, Technical documentation
Office Tools: Microsoft Excel, Word, PowerPoint
Languages: Spanish (Native), English (C1), German (A2), Arabic (Basic)

SOFT SKILLS

Written and Oral Communication, Time Management and Prioritization
Attention to Detail, Working Under Pressure, Problem-Solving
Curiosity and Growth Mindset, Fast Learner, Leadership, Positive Attitude

PROJECTS

Golden Image (2025) Golden Image Report

- Achieved **100% compliance** with OpenSCAP by hardening a Rocky Linux 9 minimal ISO from scratch.
- Configured Firewalld, Fail2ban, SSH, password policies, partitioning, and automated updates (DNF Automatic).

Multi-Site Enterprise Network Simulation (2026, in progress)

- Simulating a four-branch company in a team of four, each managing one site on VMware ESXi in the university's academic cloud.
- Deploying role-based Linux VMs (firewall, DHCP with ISC Kea, DNS with BIND), administered remotely over SSH from WSL.
- Built a site-to-site IPsec VPN (Libreswan, IKEv2, AES-256) and verified encrypted traffic with tcpdump.

She Speaks Power Challenge 2026 - CTF Write-up Google Drive

- Led a team with no prior CTF experience to a **Top 10** placement, solving OSINT, web, binary exploitation, and steganography challenges under time pressure.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Cisco Network Security Support Technician (Mar 2025 - Mar 2030) - Network Certificate
- Cisco Cybersecurity Support Technician (Apr 2024 - Apr 2029) - Cybersecurity Certificate